

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 196

By Southerland

A RESOLUTION to recognize Elena Pate of Unicoi County Middle School upon her selection as a 2024–2025 Kiwanis Club Teacher of the Year.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to specially recognize those outstanding teachers who have devoted their careers to providing the highest-quality education for Tennessee's students; and

WHEREAS, Elena Pate is one such estimable educator, who has distinguished herself as a professional of the greatest dedication, ability, and integrity; and

WHEREAS, an educator at Unicoi County Middle School (UCMS), Elena Pate was recently named a 2024–2025 Teacher of the Year by the Kiwanis Club of Erwin; and

WHEREAS, for the past two years, Ms. Pate has played a key role in the school's 4-H programs, as well as serving as the main instructor for the BB shooting program and co-instructor for the archery program; she leads the STARS after-school program and supports Unicoi County Middle School sports, band, gymnastics, and drama activities; and

WHEREAS, Elena Pate is also a member of the school-wide leadership team and the UCMS social committee, and she oversees the annual Veterans Day program; in addition, she helps lead the Student Life Committee, a student-driven group focused on improving UCMS; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Pate is an extremely talented and compassionate educator who has worked assiduously throughout her career in education to motivate her students, fellow teachers, and staff to reach their full potential as scholars, professionals, and citizens; and

WHEREAS, Elena Pate truly serves as an inspiration to the faculty and staff at Unicoi County Middle School, and her friendship and counsel are highly valued by those who are fortunate to know her; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Pate epitomizes the dedicated educator who is wholly committed to the highest ideals of public service and quality education for all, and she should be specially recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and congratulate Elena Pate on being chosen as a 2024–2025 Teacher of the Year by the Kiwanis Club of Erwin, commend her exceptional service to the children of Tennessee, salute her professional expertise and personal excellence, and wish her much continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.